

ITALY 2015

Table of Contents

1. Overview of the tax-benefit system	1
2. Unemployment insurance	2
3. Unemployment assistance	10
4. Social assistance	12
5. Housing benefits for rented accommodation	13
6. Family benefits	16
7. Childcare for pre-school children	21
8. Employment-conditional benefits	22
9. Lone-parent benefits	23
10. Tax system	24
11. Part-time work	28
12. Policy developments	28
Social security contributions to general government	29
Social security contributions paid to institutions outside general government	29
Payroll taxes	29

1. Overview of the tax-benefit system

1.1. Average Worker wage (AW)

The national currency is the Euro (EUR). In 2015, EUR 0.75 was equal to USD 1. In that year the average worker earned EUR 30 710 (Secretariat estimate).

2. Unemployment insurance

There were three main types of unemployment benefits available prior to 2013: a) Ordinary unemployment benefits (included in our model up to and including 2012), b) Wage supplementation funds (known as *Cassa Integrazione Guadagni* – henceforth CIG, either ordinary or special), and c) Mobility benefits.

The reform of the unemployment benefits presented in 2011 was introduced gradually starting in 2013 and will be in full operation in 2017. This reform changed the former scheme in a radical way. The new *Assicurazione Sociale per l'Impiego* (ASPI), Social Insurance for Employment replaces ordinary unemployment benefits and mobility benefits. In our modelling, the ASPI has replaced the Ordinary Unemployment Benefits from 2013.

In December 2014, the Italian Parliament passed an enabling law (Jobs Act) delegating Government to pursue a comprehensive reform of the labour market. Among other guidelines, the Government decided to strengthen and streamline social safety net. The enabling law, giving mandate to the Government to fully implement the Jobs Act within summer 2015, entered into force on 16th December 2014. As of September 2015, the Italian Government has completed the implementing process of the Enabling Law.

A new unemployment benefit scheme (NASPI) extended in coverage and duration was adopted in March 2015 and enforced on 1st of May 2015, based on employees' social contributions accrued in the last four years. The maximum duration of the new support measure is 24 months, and the allowance amounts up to a maximum of EUR 1,300. The March decree also introduced an unemployment benefit for project workers (DIS-COLL) and a mean tested allowance for low income long term unemployed after expiration of NASPI (the so-called ASDI). This new reform entered into force when the previous Fornero reform was partially enforced. The old ASPI then continued to survive for those who were unemployed before 1st May 2015.

CIG has been reviewed in order to better balance between workers' and companies' safeguard and the need for a quicker reallocation of resources from bad to best performing sectors and business. With the decree adopted in September 2015 a unified regulation has been drafted, replacing a previously fragmented code consisting of 15 different laws. The duration of the allowance has been reduced to a maximum of 24 months, at the same time extending covered sectors and business up to include additional around 1.5 million workers in the insurance scheme, including apprentices.

Unemployment insurance is compulsory for private sector employees. Before the last reform, unemployment benefits were paid only to workers who were hired with permanent or fixed term contracts, but starting from 1st May 2015 a DIS-COLL has been introduced for 'atypical workers' who pay social security contributions to a special fund known as 'gestione separata'.

For the purposes of the OECD Tax-Benefit model, the NASPI system is implemented in the 2015 model.

ASPI scheme

Program name in local language		Assicurazione Sociale per l'Impiego (ASPI), phased in fully in 2017
Insurance is voluntary(V) or compulsory(C) for employees		C
Employment record (E) and contribution (C) conditions		E + C: 52 weeks of contributions in the two years preceding
Waiting period (days)		8
Maximum duration (months)		12
Upgrading mechanism of the benefit		No automatic adjustment
Calculation of unemployment insurance benefit:	initial benefit as % of calculation base	75% for prior monthly wages <EUR 1,192.98; for higher wages benefit is increased by 25% of the difference between the worker's wage and this threshold
	benefit at the end of legal entitlement period in % of calculation base	Reduced by 15% after first 6 months, by 30% following 6 months
	Calculation base(2)	Gross
	Permitted employment and disregards when receiving unemployment insurance benefit	No
Benefit provision (eligibility (E), generosity (G)) varies with	Age	G: + benefit duration (8 months <50 years, 12 months if 55 or older)
	family situation	0
	contract type	0
	Other	G: - benefit duration on Mini-ASPI (if not eligible for full ASPI): 50% of contribution record in past year

Reference date for all information is **July 1st 2015**

Country chapter for OECD series *Benefits and Wages* (www.oecd.org/els/social/workincentives)

NASPI scheme

Program name in local language		Nuova Assicurazione per l'Impiego (NASPI)
Insurance is voluntary(V) or compulsory(C) for employees		C
Employment record (E) and contribution (C) conditions		E + C: 13 weeks of contributions in the four years preceding the unemployment event as well as 30 days of actual work in the 12 months prior to the beginning of the period of unemployment
Waiting period (days)		8
Maximum duration (months)		24
Upgrading mechanism of the benefit		No automatic adjustment
Calculation of unemployment insurance benefit:	initial benefit as % of calculation base	75% for prior monthly wages <EUR 1,195; for higher wages benefit is increased by 25% of the difference between the worker's wage and this threshold. Maximum amount is EUR 1,300
	benefit at the end of legal entitlement period in % of calculation base	Reduced by 3% per month from the first day of the fourth month
	Calculation base(2)	Gross
	Permitted employment and disregards when receiving unemployment insurance benefit	No
Benefit provision (eligibility (E), generosity (G)) varies with	Age	
	family situation	0
	contract type	0
	Other	

DIS-COLL

Program name in local language		Indennità di disoccupazione per i lavoratori con rapporto di collaborazione coordinata (DIS-COLL)
Insurance is voluntary(V) or compulsory(C) for employees		C
Employment record (E) and contribution (C) conditions		E + C: At least 3 months of contributions in the period from 1 January of the previous year plus 1 month in unemployment as well as a collaboration of at least 1 month with income at least equal to half of the amount that gives right to one month of contribution
Waiting period (days)		8
Maximum duration (months)		6 months
Upgrading mechanism of the benefit		No automatic adjustment
Calculation of unemployment insurance benefit:	initial benefit as % of calculation base	75% for prior monthly wages <EUR 1,195; for higher wages benefit is increased by 25% of the difference between the worker's wage and this threshold. Maximum amount is EUR 1,300
	benefit at the end of legal entitlement period in % of calculation base	Reduced by 3% per month from the first day of the fourth month
	Calculation base(2)	Gross
	Permitted employment and disregards when receiving unemployment insurance benefit	No
Benefit provision (eligibility (E), generosity (G)) varies with	Age	
	family situation	0
	contract type	0
	Other	

2.1 Conditions for receipt

ASPI (replacing Ordinary unemployment benefits) is provided to individuals insured with the National Social Security Institute (*Istituto Nazionale per la Previdenza Sociale*, INPS) for at least two years and having accumulated at least 52 weeks of contributions in the two years preceding the ending of the employment. ASPI will be assigned regardless of the sector the worker belongs to, his or her professional qualification and the size of the business. It will be extended to categories hitherto excluded, such as apprentices and members of cooperatives.

NASPI (replacing ASPI and MINI ASPI) was adopted in March 2015 and enforced on 1st of May 2015. It requires 13 weeks of contributions in the four years preceding the unemployment event as well as 30 days of actual work in the 12 months prior to the beginning of the period of unemployment. NASPI is intended for all workers who have involuntarily lost their jobs. The only excluded ones are permanent public employees and temporary and permanent agricultural workers.

DIS-COLL was adopted in March 2015 and enforced on 1st of May 2015. DIS-COLL is provided to atypical workers who pay social security contributions to a special fund known as ‘gestione separata’ and that involuntarily lost their jobs. It requires at least 3 months of contributions in the period from 1 January of the previous year plus 1 month in unemployment, as well as a collaboration of at least 1 month with income at least equal to half of the amount that gives right to one month of contribution.

Mobility benefits are provided in case of collective dismissals by firms eligible for benefit from the CIGs and in case of individual dismissal of workers already in CIGs or under bankruptcy proceedings.¹ The bankruptcy proceeding will be no more an eligibility conditions starting from January 1, 2016. Laid-off workers, in case of collective dismissals, as of December 31, 2016 will no longer be placed in ordinary mobility.

CIG has been reviewed in order to better balance between workers’ and companies’ safeguard and the need for a quicker reallocation of resources from bad to best performing sectors and business. The reform entered into force in September 2015. The duration of the allowance has been reduced to a maximum of 24 months, at the same time extending the coverage to apprentices.

Workers receiving mobility benefits and CIGs are eligible for Socially Useful Jobs (*Lavori Socialmente Utili* or LSU), usually lasting 12 months (albeit prorogation for other 12 months is possible). Workers receiving mobility benefits have to compulsorily accept these jobs if they are asked to, otherwise they will lose their benefit. After 2002 LSU programs are under progressive dismantling.

If employed in LSU, workers receiving CIGs and mobility benefits maintain their benefit until it elapses. Afterwards, if they are still employed in LSU, they will receive a benefit of EUR 578,98 per month, which is the amount paid for LSU if the workers involved are not receiving any other benefit. For the year 2015 the amount is EUR 580,14 per month. Workers on mobility and CIGs are not the only ones eligible for LSU. Unemployed workers with an unemployment spell of at least two years which usually do not receive any income support are also eligible.

2.2 Calculation of benefit amount

2.2.1 Calculation of gross benefit

ASPI, CIG, MOBILITY BENEFITS

- a) In the case of ASPI, the benefit is 75% of the previous pay for wages below EUR 1,192.98 while for wages higher than this threshold the benefit is increased by 25% of the difference between the worker's wage and this threshold. However, the maximum amount cannot exceed a given amount defined by the Law (1,165.58 in 2014 and 1,167.91 in 2015). The benefit is reduced by 15% after the first six months of unemployment, 30% in the following six months. Workers must have paid social insurance contributions for at least one year in the two years prior unemployment.

1. Generally, mobility benefits are limited to collective dismissals (firms that have dismissed at least 5 workers in 120 days) in the manufacturing sector excluding firms with less than 15 workers.

- b) CIG (both Ordinary and Special) is 80 per cent of the average gross earnings paid for non-worked hours, with a maximum level of the benefit equal to that of unemployment benefits.
- c) Mobility benefits equal CIGs for the first 12 months. They are reduced by 20 per cent after one year, with a maximum level of benefit equal to that of unemployment benefits.

Mini - ASPI

The amount payable for the Mini-ASPI is the same as that for the full ASPI. The duration of benefit receipt is limited to 50% of the contribution record for the past 12 months.

NASPI

The amount payable for the NASPI is 75% for prior monthly wages <EUR 1,195; for higher wages benefit is increased by 25% of the difference between the worker's wage and this threshold. Maximum amount is EUR 1,300. The benefit is reduced by 3% per month from the first day of the fourth month. Workers must have paid 13 weeks of contributions in the four years preceding the unemployment event as well as 30 days of actual work in the 12 months prior to the beginning of the unemployment period.

DIS-COLL

The amount payable for the DIS-COLL is 75% for prior monthly wages <EUR 1,195; for higher wages benefit is increased by 25% of the difference between the worker's wage and this threshold. Maximum amount is EUR 1,300. The amount is reduced by 3% per month from the first day of the fourth month. Workers must have paid at least 3 months of contributions in the period from 1 January of the previous year and they must have spent one month in unemployment.

2.2.2 *Income and earnings disregards for benefit recipients and those starting a new job*

See below (income and earnings disregards)

2.2.2 *Income and earnings disregards*

Unemployment benefits are not means-tested and family benefits can be paid on top of them. It is not possible to receive a certain amount of earnings from work and still be receiving unemployment benefits except for the CIG schemes which intervene for work interruptions.

2.3 *Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits*

Tax treatment of benefit

All these benefits are taxable; concerning social security contribution, the general rule is that benefits replacing less than 80 per cent of previous income are exempt. Hence, only unemployment benefits and mobility benefits after the first year are exempt from social security contributions (although imputed contributions are attributed to the benefit recipients; this imputed contributions are not affected by the temporarily increase in the ordinary unemployment benefit, which concerns just the benefit paid to workers).

2.4 Benefit duration and waiting periods

- a) The duration of ASPI for the transitory period 2013-2015 is reported in Table 1.

Table 1. Duration of ASPI

Year of the employment ending	Age of worker		
	Less than 50 years	Equal or more than 50 years but less than 55 years	Equal or more than 55 years
2013	8 months	12 months	12 months
2014	8 months	12 months	14 months
2015	10 months	12 months	16 months

- a) Unemployment benefits are paid monthly, for a maximum of 8 months after a 7-day waiting period. For unemployed aged over-50 the duration is extended to 12 months. In the case of mini-ASPI, duration is equal to half of the number of days previously worked in the last 12 months.
- b) CIGo (ordinary CIG) is usually paid for 13 weeks but it is possible to obtain some prorogation if the firm remains in a reduction of activity for a longer period. In any case, CIGo cannot be paid for more than 12 months, whether consecutive or non-consecutive, over a period of two years.
- c) CIGs (special CIG) is normally paid for 12 up to 24 months (the length depending on the type of difficulties that the firm faces as well as on the restructuring strategy). It is possible to obtain prorogation if restructuring lasts more than 24 months. In any case, CIGs cannot be paid for more than 24 months over 5 years, according to the new discipline adopted in September 2015.
- d) The duration of mobility benefits depends on the age of the recipient and on the location of the job. For instance, workers under 40 are entitled to this benefit for 12 or 24 months, respectively, according to whether they had been working in the Centre-North or the South of Italy. Conversely, the benefit duration is extended up to 36 or 48 months respectively for workers over 50 (see Table 2 below).

Table 2. Duration of mobility benefits by age of the worker and geographical location*, year 2013-2017

	Type of benefits	Centre-North < 40	Centre-North 40-49	Centre-North >50	South < 39	South 40-49
From 1/1/2013 to 31/12/2014	Mobility	12	24	36	24	36
From 1/1/2015 to 31/12/2015	Mobility	12	18	24	12	24
From 1/1/2016 to 31/12/2016	Mobility	12	12	18	12	18
From 1/1/2017	NASPI					

Reference date for all information is **July 1st 2015**

Country chapter for OECD series *Benefits and Wages* (www.oecd.org/els/social/workincentives)

2.5 *Treatment of particular groups*

None

2.5.1 *Young persons*

2.5.2 *Older workers*

Longer durations of the benefits are established for older workers (see section 2.4).

2.5.3 *Others if applicable, including disabled*

3. Unemployment assistance

With the decree adopted in March 2015 and enforced on 1st of May 2015 the unemployment assistance ASDI (Assegno di Disoccupazione) has been introduced.

3.1 Conditions for receipt

Employment conditions and other personal conditions

3.1.1 It is provided to unemployed who after finishing NASPI, are still without jobs and :

1) belong to a household where there is a minor

2) have an age above 55 years without having completed the requirements for retirement;

3) declare an ISE not exceeding EUR 5000;

4) did not received ASDI for periods longer than 6 months in the 12 months prior to the end of NASPI and, in any case for a period of at least 24 months in the previous 5 years;

5) have signed an individual project at the employment service.

3.1.2 Contribution conditions

3.2 Calculation of benefit amount

3.2.1 The amount of ASDI is 75 percent of last NASPI if not higher than social allowance (EUR 448.07). This amount may be increased based on the number of dependent children as below

Number of children	Increase (EUR) per month
1	89.70
2	116.60
3	140.80
4	163.82

3.2.1.1 Irregular additional payments

3.2.1.2 Obligations of family members

ASDI is conditioned to an individual project, containing specific commitments in terms of active job search, availability to participate in training initiatives, acceptance of suitable job offers. Participation to these initiatives is compulsory, under penalty of losing the benefit.

Reference date for all information is **July 1st 2015**

Country chapter for OECD series *Benefits and Wages* (www.oecd.org/els/social/workincentives)

3.2.2 *Income and earnings disregards for benefit recipients and those starting a new job*

3.3 ***Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits***

3.4 ***Benefit duration and waiting periods***

Maximum 6 months

3.5 ***Treatment of particular groups***

3.5.1 *Young persons*

3.5.2 *Older workers*

3.5.3 *Others if applicable*

4. Social assistance

Italy does not yet provide a universal income support scheme, except for a social benefit (the so-called *Assegno Sociale* – “social allowance” – previously known as *pensione sociale* – “social pension”) covering people aged over 65 without other sources of income. At local level there can be some provisions for people in need, but these initiatives do not follow national guidelines. However in 2016 a Support for Active Inclusion (SIA) will be enforced. It will be a means-tested measures, aimed at family with children.

4.1 Conditions for receipt

Assegno sociale: In 2014 the benefit amounts to EUR 447.61 per month (thirteen payments in one year) for income exceeding EUR 5,818 (in case of non-married recipients) and EUR 11,637 (if related to a couple). In 2015 the benefit amounts to EUR 448.52 per month (thirteen payments in one year) for income not exceeding EUR 5,830.76 (in case of non-married recipients) and EUR 11,649.86 (if related to a couple). The benefit is paid on a differential basis and is exempted from taxation.

4.2 Calculation of benefit amount

4.2.1 Calculation of gross benefit

4.2.1.1 Irregular additional payments

4.2.1.2 Obligations of family members

4.2.2 Income and earnings disregards for benefit recipients and those starting a new job

Assegno sociale: eligibility is based on individual or income of the couple when individuals are married, after income tax and social insurance contributions. Imputed income from the main house of residence (cadastral rent) is excluded from income, as well as severance payments, while any non-taxable source of income and family benefits (*Assegni al nucleo familiare*, see below) are included in this income base. The benefit is tax-exempt.

4.3 Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits

4.4 Benefit duration and waiting periods

The payment starts after one month of the application submission.

4.5 Treatment of particular group

4.5.1 Young persons

4.5.2 Older workers

4.5.3 Others if applicable, including disabled

5. Housing benefits for rented accommodation

Regular housing benefits	Program name in local language		None applicable
	Entitlement depends on	Household type/size	Yes
		Income	Yes
		Dwelling size	No
		Geographic location	Yes
		Actual rental cost	Yes
	Description of regular housing benefit		Rent subsidies usually are granted whenever household taxable income falls short of twice the amount of the statutory minimum pension and the rent exceeds 14 per cent of this income. Requirements and benefit amounts differ at region and municipal levels. In 2014 government allocated no resources to the housing fund.
	Uprating mechanism of the benefit		None
Housing related support through other benefits		Tax credits for low-income renters	

In Italy housing policies are addressed both to those who buy the main house of residence (usually in the form of tax allowances related to mortgage loan interests up to a threshold of EUR 4,000, rebates on property transfer taxes; low interest loans which are means-tested and regulated by local legislation, all in the case of first-time buyers) as well as to those who rent a house.

The rent assistance provisions usually take the form of :

- Means-tested tax reliefs.
- Rent subsidies for low-income people. These subsidies are provided at local level but have a very low coverage. They are discussed in this report, however no funding was made available to this scheme in 2012-2014, therefore they are not included in the model results.
- Rent-limiting legislation, mainly regulated at local level. This consists of restrictions to rent increases for those with a rental agreement.
- Controlled rents for State-owned dwellings.

There is typically no difference between national rules for pensioners and recipients in their income ages, with the exception of some benefits provided at local level and addressed to the poor and the elderly (over 65). Exceptions occurring for the means tested tax reliefs are described below.

5.1 Conditions for receipt

- Tax credits are granted to people on rent for the main house of residence, if they have an 'affordable rent contract' (contratti convenzionati); these reliefs are means-tested against taxable income.

- b) Rent subsidies are granted whenever household taxable income falls short of twice the amount of the statutory minimum pension ($\text{EUR } 6\,441 \times 2 = 12\,882$ per year) and the rent exceeds 14 per cent of this income. Such requirements can be modified at local level. These subsidies are conditional on the availability of funds. The central government decides how much resources are allocated to the National Fund for Rental Support (Fondo nazionale di sostegno alle locazioni). These resources are then distributed across regions, who can match them with their own resources. Regions also define the eligibility threshold – both in terms of household income and rent as share of income. The fund is then distributed among municipalities in each region that manage its delivery. For 2012 and 2013 the government allocated no resources to this fund. As such, no local funding is assumed either and therefore this benefit is not modelled for 2012 and 2013.
- c) Dependent on rental agreement.
- d) Limited rents - known as social rents - for people with low-income (below twice the amount of the statutory minimum pension), are set for some categories of State-owned dwellings. Eligibility is based on the family size and claimants are ranked in a list set by the municipalities. It is also important to add that most of the stock of buildings so rented, have been attributed in the past, and the new additions are relatively small. State-owned dwellings, specifically those owned by the Social Security State Agencies, are generally rented at preferential prices, usually below market rents.

5.2 *Calculation of benefit amount*

- a) The Italian tax system provides rent tax reliefs to households who rent their main house of residence. The amount of tax relief depends on the household's gross income. Two specific thresholds are used: EUR 15,493.71 (y1) and EUR 30,987.41 (y2); no credit is provided if income is greater than y2. The tax allowance amounts to EUR 300.00 if income is lower than y1 and EUR 150.00 if income is between y1 and y2. A greater tax allowance is granted to: (1) households with affordable rent contracts ("contratti convenzionali"); (2) people aged between 20 and 30, in the first three years of residence; (3) dependent workers who move to a different place because of work, in the first three years of residence. The tax allowance amounts to EUR 495.80 (1); EUR 991.60 (2 and 3) if income is lower than y1 and to EUR 247.90 (1); EUR 495.84 (3) if income ranges between y1 and y2. A tax allowance equal to 19% of rent is also granted to university students who "study away from their hometown" as long as the rent is no higher than EUR 2,633. Tax payers can claim for the total credit in the same year (although it usually takes several years before the credit is actually paid from the Department) or carry it forward and deduct it from the next year's income tax.
- b) Rent subsidies differ in eligibility conditions and benefit amounts at the regional as well as at the municipality level. Moreover, the maximum amount varies with the size of the city's population. In some municipalities eligibility depends also on the household wealth and resources can be means-tested through a partially modified ISE.
- c) Rent-limiting legislation varies according to regional provisions.

5.2.1 *Calculation of gross benefit*

Reference date for all information is **July 1st 2015**

Country chapter for OECD series *Benefits and Wages* (www.oecd.org/els/social/workincentives)

5.2.2 *Income and earnings disregards*

5.2.3 *Costs eligible for housing benefits*

5.3 *Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits*

5.4 *Treatment of particular groups*

5.4.1 *Young persons*

5.4.2 *Older workers*

5.4.3 *Others if applicable, including disabled*

6. Family benefits

Program name (local name in parentheses if available)			Child benefit	Large family allowance
Type of benefit			Targeted	Targeted
Eligibility criteria	Age limits for children up to and including (in parentheses if student)		18 (21)	18 (21)
	Other conditions for receipt of benefit (including requirements for conditional cash transfers (CCT))		At least 70% of parents' earnings must derive from employed work or unemployment or employment pension benefits), reduced in proportion of days not worked if working <24 hours	Families with at least 3 children <18 years and ISE < EUR 8,555.99
Uprating mechanism of the benefit			Automatic adjustment linked to the variations of cost of living	Automatic adjustment linked to the variations of cost of living
Benefit amount	Benefit amount per child varies with (where +/- denotes increase/decrease: +++/--- above proportional, ++/-- proportional, +/- below proportional, +/- variable, 0: no effect)	Age of child	0	0
		Number of children	+	+
	Earnings disregard		Benefit based on household taxable income	Benefit based on household taxable income
	Withdrawal rate		n.a.	No specified rate
	Assets part of means test		...	...

6.1 Conditions for receipt

- a) Family allowances. The benefit is means-tested against total household taxable income. A household is defined as the recipient, his/her spouse, and his/her dependent child/children under 18. The benefit is not only devoted to families with children and for instance a low-income

couple with no children is eligible for the benefit. The family allowance scheme grants cash transfers to employees and former-employee pensioners and unemployment benefit recipients, but does not cover self-employed.

- b) Maternity allowances, enacted in 1999, are granted by municipalities and are addressed to mothers with children below 1 year of age. The benefit is means-tested. Generally speaking, beneficiaries are unemployed housewives or job seekers. In 2014 the amount is EUR 338.21 per month.
- c) Allowances to households with at least three children under 18, enacted in 1999, are addressed to households with at least three children younger than 18, whose ISE lies below a given threshold.

In 2009 a new temporary measure devoted to fighting poverty was introduced, the so-called *Social Card*. This was also confirmed in 2013, 2014 and 2015.

The 2015 Stability Law introduced a new child allowance, the so-called *Assegno di natalità-Bonus bebè*. The amount of the allowances will be between EUR 80 and EUR 160 for families who have a child or may have it. The child will be born in the period between 1 January 2015 and 31 December 2017 and the allowance lasts for three years. Household's ISE should be below EUR 25,000. The benefit will amount to EUR 960 in 12 months; and for those who report an ISE lower than EUR 7,000, the amount will be EUR 1,920 per year. This benefit is payable from the child birth date until he reaches three years of age or, in the case of adoption, at the time of his entrance into the family.

Social card: this is a voucher (in the form of a pre-paid credit card) amounting to EUR 40 per month that can be used to buy groceries and pay the energy and gas bills. Recipients can be either aged over 65 or less than 3 years old (in this case actually the benefit recipient is the parent). Eligibility is based on very strict conditions (see table 2).

Table 2 – Eligibility rules for the Social card.

	Recipients aged over 65	Recipients aged less the 3
Recipients must be below the tax threshold (their income must not be chargeable to the income tax)	X	
Pension and social assistance benefits (lower than EUR 6,795.38 if aged less than 70, EUR 9,060.51 if aged over 70)	X	
Equivalent household income lower than EUR 6,795.38 (computed using the ISE equivalence scale, see table 4).	X	X
Holder of electricity and gas contracts	X	X
Car owners	X	X
Owner (by at least 25%) of house of residence	X	X
(equivalent) Financial wealth (computed using the ISE equivalence	X	X

scale) below EUR 15,000

6.2 Calculation of benefit amount

6.2.1 Calculation of gross benefit

Family allowances are cash transfers that vary with the number of family members and household taxable income. The benefit is paid by employers on behalf of the National Social Security Institute (*Istituto Nazionale per la Previdenza Sociale*, INPS) and the income brackets are adjusted yearly to the consumer price index. The scheme covers different household typologies, ranging from households where both spouses are present (with or without children), to orphaned individuals, to divorced, separated, widowed recipients, or individuals with spouse living in a foreign country. Eligible households include the recipient, his/her spouse, children if aged less than 18 or 21 when they are students (or 26 if living in households with at least 4 children), dependent grandchildren, brothers or sisters. Household income includes taxable as well as non-taxable income. Eligibility to the benefit requires that income be at least 70 per cent of income from dependent work or pensions from dependent work.

Part-time workers receive the entire amount of the benefit if they work at least 24 hours per week, while if they work less than 24 hours the benefit is reduced depending on the number of days worked. For instance, if the recipient works only one day then the benefit is 1/6 of the full amount. It should be noted that if the recipient works a few hours every day of the week then no reduction applies since the reduction depends on the number of days worked rather than the number of hours.

Maternity allowances granted by municipalities in 2014 amount to EUR 338,21 for five months (EUR 1.691,05 per five months) and are granted to mothers whose ISE (see section 1, note 1) lies below a given threshold or do not earn income. In the case of insured mothers receiving maternity benefits smaller than this amount, the allowance is paid on a differential basis. For a three-member family the threshold is EUR 35.256,84, while for households with different size the threshold is modified according to the equivalence scale in Table 4. In 2015 maternity allowances granted by municipalities amount to EUR 338.89 for five months (EUR 1.694,45 per five months).

Another scheme of maternity allowance is provided at national level and is addressed to mothers who have resigned their job during their pregnancy and have paid contributions for at least three months over the period between 18 and 9 months preceding birth. Mothers who receive this benefit are not eligible for other maternity allowances.

Table 4. Equivalence scale to be applied to the Indicator of Economic Situation (ISE)

Number of family members	Parameters
1	1
2	1.57
3	2.04
4	2.46
5	2.85*

* For households with more than 5 members, the parameter is increased by 0.35 for each member above the fifth. Moreover, the parameters shown in Table 2 are increased by:

- 0.2 for lone parents with children.

- 0.5 for each disabled member of the household.
- 0.2 for couples with children, when both parents are working.

Source: Legislative Decree n. 109 of 18 June 1998.

The allowance for households with at least three children aged less than 18 amounts to EUR 139.49 in 2014 and EUR 141.30 per month in 2015 (EUR 1,813.37 per thirteen months in 2014 and EUR 1,836.9 per thirteen months in 2015 respectively), and is granted to households whose ISE lies below a threshold. With reference to a five-member family this threshold is EUR 25,384.91 in 2015 and, as for the maternity allowance, is modified according to the ISE equivalence scale (table 4).

The total amount of the benefit is provided in the case whereby total ISE is smaller than or equal to the difference between the threshold and the value of the maximum benefit. The benefit is paid on a reduced base when total ISE lies between the difference between the threshold and the yearly amount and the threshold.

This benefit and the maternity allowance as well as the corresponding thresholds, are adjusted yearly to the consumer price index. Both benefits are administered at the local level and provided by INPS on behalf of municipalities.

6.2.1.1 Irregular additional payments

6.2.2 Income and earnings disregards

As explained above in assessing family allowances total household taxable income is considered; however, the benefit is granted only if at least 70 per cent of the income stems from wages and salaries and former-employees' pensions.

Social card: the income concept relevant for the benefit eligibility is taxable income. Income from the main house of residence is included in this base.

6.3 Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits

Family allowances, the maternity allowance, the allowance for households with at least three children under age are exempt from income taxation.

6.4 Treatment of particular groups

Both the income brackets and the amounts of allowances to dependent workers are modified whenever disabled people and/or lone parents are present within the family.

The equivalence scale set for mother allowances and for allowance to households with at least three children is modified when there are disabled people and/or lone parents within the family and/or when both parents work (see Table 4). Moreover, households with disabled members and/or with children have a priority right for the minimum income support benefit.

Free books and scholarships are provided to students belonging to families with an ISE below a given threshold, varying with the family size according to the ISE equivalence scale (Table 4).

Reference date for all information is **July 1st 2015**

Country chapter for OECD series *Benefits and Wages* (www.oecd.org/els/social/workincentives)

6.4.1 *Young persons*

6.4.2 *Older workers*

6.4.3 *Others if applicable, including disabled*

7. Childcare for pre-school children

Childcare provisions for children 0-3 years old are administered at the municipal level. They have a very high degree of variability at national level, as well as at regional level and even for the same province or municipality. Therefore it is not possible to identify a "representative" case. Furthermore, there is no guarantee that such services are actually provided (or financed) by the public administration depending on the amount of available resources.

7.1 Out-of-pocket childcare fees paid by parents

Full-time childcare

The rebates of out-of-pocket childcare fees paid by parents is not universally provided but eventually administered at municipal level. In some cases a means-tested voucher is paid by local administrations in order to cover such expenditures, under the condition of using it only in certified institutions. This holds for children 0-3 years old. In the pre-school years, childcare services are offered almost universally and are free of charge for the families.

Part-time childcare

N/A

7.2 Child-care benefits for formal centre-based care

Child-care services are essentially nurseries for children below 3 years of age. They are provided according to rules set by regional laws and implemented at municipal level with different criteria. These provisions mainly consist of in-kind means-tested benefits. Generally speaking, the household income and composition are considered to rank eligibility and fees. Above 3 years of age, while not compulsory, the public system provides for an almost universal and free of charge coverage (except for food) through the State and municipal "maternal" schools.

7.2.1 Conditions for receipt

7.2.2 Calculation of benefit amount

7.2.2.1 Calculation of gross benefit

7.2.2.2 Income and earnings disregards

7.2.3 Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits

7.2.4 Treatment of particular groups, including disabled

7.3 Child care allowance for children not using child care centers

8. Employment-conditional benefits

Assegno sociale: In 2014 the benefit amounts to EUR 442.30 per month (thirteen payments in one year) for income not exceeding EUR 5,749.70 (in case of not married recipients) and EUR 11,499.80 (if related to a couple). The benefit is paid on a differential basis, is exempted from taxation. In 2015 the benefit amounts to EUR 448,52 30 per month (thirteen payments in one year) for income not exceeding EUR 5,830.76 (in case of not married recipients) and EUR 11,661.52 (if related to a couple).

Family allowances described in section 6 are actually employment-conditional benefit. Supplementary benefits (*Integrazioni al Minimo*) for low-income households are granted to recipients of old-age and survivors' pensions whenever their accrued benefits fall short of a statutory minimum, set to EUR 501.38 per month in 2014. Eligibility for the supplementary benefits requires that the claimant's personal taxable income - if married, both partners' cumulated incomes - be below a given threshold. Beneficiaries receive the full amount if income is lower than EUR 6,517.94, a reduced amount if income is lower than EUR 13,035.88 (respectively, EUR 19,553.82 and EUR 26,071.76 if married). While the 1995 main pension reform abolished supplementary benefits for new enrolees, no changes were introduced for all the other cases.

8.1 Conditions for receipt

8.2 Calculation of benefit amount

8.2.1 Calculation of gross benefit

8.3 Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits

8.4 Benefit duration

8.5 Treatment of particular group

8.5.1 Young persons

8.5.2 Older workers

8.5.3 Others if applicable, including disabled

9. Lone-parent benefits

Lone parents are entitled to the family allowances described in section 6.

9.1 *Conditions for receipt*

9.2 *Calculation of benefit amount*

9.2.1 *Calculation of gross benefit*

9.2.1.1 *Irregular additional payments*

9.2.2 *Income and earnings disregards*

9.3 *Tax treatment of benefit and interaction with other benefits*

9.4 *Benefit duration*

9.5 *Treatment of particular group*

9.5.1 *Young persons*

9.5.2 *Older workers*

9.5.3 *Others if applicable, including disabled*

10. Tax system**10.1 Income tax****10.1.1 Tax allowances and credits**

Specific tax credits are provided for pensioners. The Italian income tax system allows tax credits decreasing in income and varying with the income source (dependent work, self-employment, pensions). Such credits actually play an important role as the maximum eligible amount defines the no-tax area, that is the tax exemption threshold. This amounts to EUR 8000 for employees, EUR 7500 for pensioners, EUR 7750 for pensioners aged over 75, 4800 for self-employed.

10.1.1.1 Standard allowances

Social security contributions due by law

10.1.1.2 Standard tax credits

All the tax credits in Italy are non-refundable.

The basic employee tax credit is equal to EUR 1880.

From 2014, an additional refundable tax credit of EUR 640 was introduced for employees with income between EUR 8146 and EUR 24 000, with a phase-out for income between EUR 24 000 and EUR 26 000. This credit was increased to EUR 960 on a permanent basis as of 2015.

Taxable income (EUR)	Fiscal Bonus (EUR)
Up to 8 145	0
From 8 146 to 24 000	960
From 24 001 to 26 000	$960 \times (26\,000 - \text{taxable income}) / 2\,000$
More than 26 000	0

- Standard tax credits

The PAYE tax credit is defined as a function of net income:

Taxable income (EUR)	PAYE tax credit (EUR)
Up to 8 000	1 880
From 8 001 to 28 000	$\text{Maximum tax credit} + 902 \times (28\,000 - \text{taxable income}) / 20\,000$
From 28 001 to 55 000	$\text{Maximum tax credit} \times (55\,000 - \text{taxable income}) / 27\,000$
More than 55 000	0

The maximum value for the tax credit depends on the level of taxable income:

Level of taxable income (EUR)	Maximum tax credit (EUR)
From 8 001 to 15 000	978
From 15 001 to 23 000	978
From 23 001 to 24 000	978
From 24 001 to 25 000	978
From 25 001 to 26 000	978
From 26 001 to 27 700	978
From 27 701 to 28 000	978
From 28 001 to 55 000	978

- Tax credits for family dependents

The tax credits for family dependants, which have replaced the former tax allowances, are as follows:

Family tax credits (EUR) *	Amount (EUR)
Spouse	800 decreasing to 0 for net income over 80 000
Children Under three years of age Over three years of age	1220 decreasing to 0 for net income over 95 000 950 decreasing to 0 for net income over 95 000
Other dependent relatives	750 decreasing to 0 for net income over 80 000
(*) Tax credits are granted for family dependents earning less than EUR 2 840.51	

The spouse tax credit is calculated as a function of net income:

Level of taxable income (EUR)	Amount of tax credit (EUR)
Up to 15 000	$800 - 110 \times \text{taxable income} / 15\,000$
From 15 001 to 29 000	690
From 29 001 to 29 200	700
From 29 201 to 34 700	710
From 34 701 to 35 000	720
From 35 001 to 35 100	710

From 35 101 to 35 200	700
From 35 201 to 40 000	690
From 40 001 to 80 000	$690 \cdot (80\,000 - \text{taxable income}) / 40\,000$
More than 80 000	0

The child tax credit is calculated as a function of net income:

- for families with only one child: $950 \cdot (95\,000 - \text{taxable income}) / 95\,000$;
- for families with more than one child the amount of 95 000 is increased by 15 000 for each child other than the first, for every children (including the first one).

Families with more than 3 children receive an additional tax credit of EUR 200 per child.

A lone parent receives an actual tax credit for the first child equal to the maximum of the spouse tax credit and the child tax credit.

Tax credits for children have to be equally shared between the parents; different shares are no longer allowed.

If the spouse's tax liable net of the PAYE tax credit is less than his/her share (50 per cent) in the child tax credit, the entire child tax credit is provided to the principal earner.

10.1.2 *Income tax schedule (central government income tax)*

The following tax schedule is applied to taxable income:

Bracket (EUR)	Rate (%)
up to 15 000	23
over 15 000 up to 28 000	27
over 28 000 up to 55 000	38
over 55 000 up to 75 000	41
over 75 000	43

Decree-Law n. 138 of 13th August 2011 introduced the “Contributo di Solidarietà” for the 2011-2013 tax periods, that is a 3% “solidarity contribution” on the portion of income higher than 300.000 euros (the amount paid is deductible from PIT base)”

10.1.3 *State and local income taxes*

10.1.3.1 *Regional surcharge tax*

This surcharge tax has been introduced in 1997. The tax is levied by each region on resident taxpayers' total taxable income at a discretionary rate, which must fall within an established range. As from the year 2000 this range is 0.9 per cent – 1.4 per cent.

In December 2011, with the DL 201/2011, the minimum state rate has been increased from 0.9% to 1.23%

The Tax and Benefits Model includes the regional surcharge tax paid in the most representative city which is Rome (Lazio); the rate is 3.33 per cent in 2015. The rate is 1.73% for income under 15000 euros.

10.1.3.2 Local surcharge tax

This surcharge tax has been introduced in 1999. The tax may be levied by each local government at an initial rate that cannot exceed 0.2 per cent. If the tax is levied, the local government can increase the initial rate, on a yearly basis, up to a maximum of 0.5 per cent. Each yearly increase cannot exceed 0.2 per cent. As from 2012, municipalities can increase the rate up to 0.8. A 0.9 special rate can be introduced by Roma Capitale Local Government.

The Tax and Benefits Model includes the local surcharge tax paid in the most representative city which is Rome; the rate is 0.9 per cent in 2015.

10.2 Treatment of family income

Income tax is assessed on an individual basis. However presence of a dependent spouse as well as dependent children is taken into account through specific tax credits. Dependent individuals must earn income below EUR 2840.51, provided that live within the family and or receive alimony checks. The tax credit for dependent spouse decreases with before tax individual income net of cadastral rent from the main house of residence.

10.3 Social security contributions and payroll taxes

10.3.1 Contributions payable by employees and benefit recipients

- Rate and ceiling
 - The average rate is 9.49 per cent on earnings up to EUR 46 123.
 - The average rate is 10.49 per cent on earnings over EUR 46 123 and up to EUR 100 324.
 - For earnings exceeding EUR 100 324, the employee pays a fixed amount given by $(0.0949 \times 46\,123) + 0.1049 \times (100\,324 - 46\,123)$.
- Distinction by marital status or sex
 - None.

10.3.2 Contributions payable by employers

- Contributions equal 32.08 per cent on earnings up to EUR 100 324. For earnings exceeding EUR 100 324, the employer pays a fixed amount given by $0.3208 \times 100\,324$.

10.3.3 Payroll taxes

10.4 Treatment of particular group

10.4.1 Young persons

10.4.2 Older workers

10.4.3 Others if applicable

11. Part-time work

11.1 *Special benefit rules for part-time work*

11.2 *Special tax and social security contribution rules for part-time work*

12. Policy developments

12.1 *Policy changes introduced: 2nd July 2014– 1st July 2015*

After a new Government took office in February 2014, some important reforms were enacted. In December 2014, the Italian Parliament passed the Enabling Law on labour market reform (the so-called Jobs Act), delegating Government to pursue a comprehensive reform of the labour market. Among other guidelines, the Government decided to strengthen and streamline social safety net. The enabling law gave mandate to the Government to fully implement the Jobs Act within summer 2015. As of September 2015, the Italian Government completed the implementing process of the Enabling Law.

A new unemployment benefit scheme (NASPI) extended in coverage and duration was adopted in March 2015 and enforced on 1st of May 2015, based on employees' social contributions accrued in the last four years. The maximum duration of the new support measure is 24 months, and the allowance amounts up to a maximum of EUR 1,300. The March decree also introduced an unemployment benefit for project workers (DIS-COLL) and a mean tested allowance for low income long term unemployed after expiration of NASPI (ASDI). This new reform entered into force when the previous Fornero reform was partially enforced. The old ASPI then continued to survive for those who were unemployed before 1st May 2015.

The contributory method introduced in 1995 for new enrollees, but on a partial basis for workers who had paid contributions for more less than 18 years, will be applied to all workers starting in January 2012. The reform also changes the retirement age for women (62 increased gradually to 66 up to 2018), actually equalizing women retirement age to men.

As it concerns the personal tax system a new property tax was introduced in 2012, the *Imposta Comunale sugli Immobili* (IMU) that replaces ICI (*Imposta Comunale sugli Immobili*), abolished in 2008 for the main house of residence. The ordinary rate of taxation is 0,4% for the main house and 0,76% for other properties. The final tax rate is defined by each municipality within a given range. The law provides a relief of EUR 200.00 for the main house of residence, increased by EUR 50 for each child aged less than 26 years living in the household.

With the stability Law for 2014 the single municipal tax IUC was introduced. The IUC went into effect on 1 January 2014. IUC includes a municipal property tax (IMU), a tax on shared municipal services (TASI) and a tax on waste (TARI). The aim of TARI is to finance the costs of waste collection and disposal.

12.2 *Future policy changes announced since 1st July 2015*

ANNEX

DEFINITION OF SOCIAL SECURITY CONTRIBUTIONS AND PAYROLL TAXES.

The following text has been adapted from Annex A of the OECD *Revenue Statistics*.

Social security contributions to general government

Classified here are all compulsory payments that confer an entitlement to receive a (contingent) future social benefit. Such payments are usually earmarked to finance social benefits and are often paid to institutions of general government that provide such benefits. However, such earmarking is not part of the definition of social security contributions and is not required for a tax to be classified here. However, conferment of an entitlement is required for a tax to be classified under this heading. So, levies on income or payroll that are earmarked for social security funds but do not confer an entitlement to benefit are excluded from this heading and shown under personal income taxes or taxes on payroll and workforce. Taxes on other bases, such as goods and services, which are earmarked for social security benefits are not shown here [...] because they generally confer no entitlement to social security benefits.

Contributions for the following types of social security benefits would, *inter alia*, be included: unemployment insurance benefits and supplements, accident, injury and sickness benefits, old-age, disability and survivors' pensions, family allowances, reimbursements for medical and hospital expenses or provision of hospital or medical services. Contributions may be levied on both employees and employers.

Social security contributions paid to institutions outside general government

Contributions to social insurance schemes which are not institutions of general government and to other types of insurance schemes, provident funds, pension funds, friendly societies or other saving schemes [are included here if they are compulsory or quasicompulsory (e.g., by virtue of agreement with professional and union organisations)]. Provident funds are arrangements under which the contributions of each employee and of the corresponding employer on his/her behalf are kept in a separate account earning interest and withdrawable under specific circumstances. Pension funds are separately organised schemes negotiated between employees and employers and carry provisions for different contributions and benefits, sometimes more directly tied to salary levels and length of service than under social security schemes.

Payroll taxes

This heading covers taxes paid by employers or employees either as a proportion of payroll or as a fixed amount per person, and which do not confer entitlement to social benefits. Examples of taxes classified here are the United Kingdom national insurance surcharge (introduced in 1977), the Swedish payroll tax (1969-1979), and the Austrian Contribution to the Family Burden Equalisation Fund and Community Tax.